

TrueLift

USER MANUAL

Your adaptive strength coach

Plan, adjust and log your routines to progress with sound judgement in every session.

www.truelift.es

Table of contents

1. Welcome to TrueLift
2. Free version and PRO version
3. First steps: set up your routine
4. Language, units and equipment
5. The five tabs
6. Routine tab
7. Your day to day: logging a session
8. Your data is the engine: what to log and why
9. How the app progresses
10. Optional features (PRO)
11. Deload mode
12. Volume tab
13. Progress tab
14. Support tools
15. Sharing your training
16. Backup
17. Recommendations by level
18. Frequently asked questions
19. About the author

1. Welcome to TrueLift

TrueLift is a strength-training app designed so that anyone can follow a serious routine, log their sets and progress with sound judgement, without needing to know anything about sports programming. You train and write down what you do; the app takes care of telling you when and how much to raise the weight, when it is wise to hold back, and how your progress is evolving over time.

The core idea is simple: progress in strength is not about adding weight any old way, but about applying small, sustainable increments at the right moment. TrueLift watches your logs (weight, repetitions, RIR, effort, daily state...) and translates all of it into a clear recommendation for your next session. The better you log, the better it coaches you: in section 8 you will see which data the engine uses and why they matter so much.

This manual walks through the app from end to end: the initial setup, every tab, all the tools, the optional features and the most frequent questions. You do not need to read it all at once; use it as a reference whenever you have doubts about any screen.

Important: TrueLift is a support tool for your training, not a substitute for medical judgement. If you have pain or health concerns, consult a professional.

2. Free version and PRO version

TrueLift is free in its essential part: you can set up your routine, log your sessions, receive the automatic weight increases and track your progress without paying anything. Some advanced features belong to the PRO version, which you can unlock with whichever payment option you prefer: subscription, annual payment or lifetime payment.

What each version includes

Feature	Free	PRO
Log sessions and automatic progression	✓	✓
Cardio, plate calculator and warm-up	✓	✓
Rest timer with alarm	✓	✓
Weekly volume and frequency	✓	✓
Progress, personal records and performance	✓	✓
Strength level ("Your level")	✓	✓
Share workouts and monthly report	✓	✓
Backups	✓	✓
Swap one exercise for another	✓	✓
Language (ES / EN / PT-BR) and kg / lb units	✓	✓
Manual deload mode	—	✓
Adjust sets, RIR, repetitions and rest	—	✓
Customize your routine at pattern level	—	✓

Feature	Free	PRO
Rename and reorder sessions and exercises	—	✓
Create new exercises in the library	—	✓
Export your routine to Excel and import routines	—	✓
PRO routines ready to train	—	✓
Create your routine with AI (questionnaire + prompt)	—	✓
Top set + back-offs	—	✓
Auto-regulation (daily state)	—	✓
HRV (heart rate variability)	—	✓
Diet phase (deficit / surplus)	—	✓
Automatically suggested deload	—	✓
Readiness-to-train indicator (0–100)	—	✓
Fatigue and pain by body region (lower / upper body)	—	✓
Reordering test for plateaus	—	✓
Cardio load integrated into fatigue signals	—	✓

In the free version, the diet phase is fixed at Maintenance, and auto-regulation and HRV are disabled. Everything else works normally.

Is PRO worth it? The free version gives you a complete progression engine that decides based on what you do in the gym. The PRO version also takes into account what happens outside of it: your sleep, your stress, your pain (and its region), your HRV, your diet phase and your cardio load. With those signals, the engine does not just decide how much to increase: it decides when to push, when to brake and when to protect you with a deload. If you take training seriously, that difference compounds into months of progress. And you can check it for free for 28 days.

Free 28-day PRO trial

You can try all the PRO features for 28 days, free and without entering any payment details. When you try to use a PRO feature (or from the Author tab), you will see the PRO version screen with the **Try 28 days free** button. Tapping it activates all the advanced features immediately.

- During the trial, the Author tab shows the days you have left, and every time you open the app a notice reminds you of it with the OK and Buy PRO version buttons.
- The start cover switches to the PRO version while the trial is active.
- When the 28 days end, the PRO features lock again and the app returns to free mode. Your routine and your history are not lost: those advanced options simply stop being available until you purchase the full version.

The trial can be used only once per user.

Buying the PRO version

To get the PRO features, tap **Buy PRO** on the PRO version screen. All payments are handled by Google Play, with the usual methods of your account (card, Google Pay, carrier billing, etc.). You can choose between three options: subscription (recurring payment you can cancel whenever you want), annual payment (a full year of PRO) and lifetime payment (a single payment that never expires). The price of each option is shown on the purchase screen itself. Once activated, your purchase is tied to your Google account: if you change phones or reinstall, tap **Restore purchase** and it will be reactivated without paying again.

3. First steps: set up your routine

The first time you open TrueLift you land on the **Set up your routine** screen. Here you define your starting point. You can return to it at any time with the settings icon (top right).

For whom?

Choose Man or Woman. This selects the most suitable base routine model as a starting point (you can customize it later).

Progression system

Decide how you want to progress:

- **Simple linear:** fixed repetitions. When you complete all sets with the target number of repetitions and the expected RIR, the app raises the weight in the next session. It is the ideal option if you have been training for less than two years, because it lets you increase frequently.
- **Double progression:** you work with a repetition range (for example 8–12). You accumulate repetitions with the same weight until you complete all sets at the top of the range; then the app gives you the new weight. It is ideal when linear progression has stalled.

Training days per week

Choose between 2 and 5 days. The routine structure (what is trained each day) adjusts automatically to the number of days chosen.

Your body weight

Select your body weight with the wheel. It is used in bodyweight or weighted exercises (pull-ups, dips, push-ups), where the weight you move includes your own body, so that strength estimates are realistic. Keep it up to date: the engine uses it both to suggest loads and to measure your real progress in those exercises (also in assisted ones), and it also feeds your strength-level classification in Progress.

When you finish, tap **Continue with this routine** to enter the app.

4. Language, units and equipment

Take a moment in the settings screen: it determines whether the weight increases TrueLift proposes are actually loadable with your equipment, and whether the app speaks your language and your units.

Language

You can use the app in **Spanish, English or Portuguese (Brazil)**. The change is immediate and affects the entire interface, the engine messages and the help tips.

Units: kg or lb

Choose whether you want to see weights in kilograms or pounds. Internally the app always keeps your data with full precision, so switching units does not rewrite your history or break the suggestions: you will simply see everything converted, including the plate settings (for example, 1.25 kg plates are shown as 2.5 lb plates).

1.25 kg (2.5 lb) plates

Turn it on if you have pairs of 1.25 kg plates (assumed unlimited). It allows finer load jumps on the barbell: instead of going up 2.5 kg per side, you can adjust by 1.25 kg per side.

Microloading (fractional plates)

Microloading has a **master switch** ("Enable microloading"), off by default. With it off, fractional plates take no part in suggestions or load rounding. If you turn it on, specify:

- **Weight of the smallest plate:** the value of the fractional plate you own (for example 0.5, 0.75 or 1 kg).
- **How many per side:** from 1 to 4, or Unlimited. This matters because, if you only have one pair of 0.5 kg plates, the app will not suggest an increase that requires three per side.
- **Include microloading on dumbbells:** turn it on if you also use fractional plates (magnetic or strapped) on your dumbbells, to allow smaller jumps than your gym's dumbbell increment.
- **Forgetfulness reminder:** if you enable it, when you finish the last exercise that uses microplates the app will ask whether you have picked them up. Very handy so you don't leave your small plates at the gym.

Standard plates (2.5 / 5 / 10 / 20 kg, and the 1.25 kg ones if you enable them) are considered unlimited.

Dumbbell increment

Enter the weight difference between one dumbbell and the next in your gym (for example, 2 kg). It is used to compute the target weight in dumbbell exercises, so that the suggested weight actually exists on your rack.

Countdown between sets

If you enable it, when you log the repetitions of a set the rest timer until the next one starts automatically. You can disable it if you prefer to control rests yourself.

Help tips and mini-glossary

With this switch on, you will see small information icons throughout the app (next to RIR, deload, e1RM, HRV, diet phase, strength levels...). Tapping them opens a short explanation of the concept. If you already master the terminology, you can hide them.

5. The five tabs

The bottom bar has five tabs. This is the overview; each one is detailed further on.

- **Routine:** your training plan. Here you see the days, the exercises, the sets, the repetitions, the RIR and the rest, and you can customize it.
- **Volume:** how many effective sets you do per muscle group per week and with what frequency, with a color reference.
- **Log:** the heart of the app. Here you record each session and log cardio. When you open the app it lands on this tab with the next session already pre-selected.
- **Progress:** charts and records. Tonnage, estimated 1RM, per-session evolution, your strength level, personal records, performance, recent readiness and the monthly report.
- **Author:** information about the author, links and PRO version activation.

At the top right, at any time, you have quick access to the plate calculator (dumbbell icon) and the settings (gear icon).

6. Routine tab

The Routine tab shows your plan organized by days/sessions (upper tabs). Each exercise appears in a card with its movement pattern, its muscle group and its parameters.

Actions on each exercise

- **Change exercise** (free): replace the exercise with another option of the same pattern and group. Useful if your gym lacks a specific machine.
- **Change pattern** (PRO): changes the movement pattern of the slot (for example, from horizontal push to vertical push).
- **Sets, RIR, Reps and Rest** (PRO): adjust each parameter with the + / – buttons. In the free version these controls show the PRO screen.
- **Remove exercise** (trash can): deletes the exercise from that day.

Under each day you have **Add exercise** (adds a new line to that session) and **Restore original routine** (undoes all your changes and returns to the preset routine).

Rename and reorder (PRO)

Each session has a **Rename session** button: you can change the day's name (for example, call it "Push" or "Legs A"). Renaming keeps that session's history so you don't lose your progress.

In addition, with PRO you can **reorder**: press and hold an exercise for two seconds to drag it to another position within the day, and do the same with the day tabs to change their order. Order is not part of the progression's identity: reordering does not alter your history, your baselines or your progression anchors.

Library and Excel templates

- **New exercise in the library** (PRO): create your own exercise (with its name, pattern and group) to use in your routines.

- **Download template (free):** you get an Excel template to plan your routine comfortably on the computer.
- **Export your routine to Excel (PRO):** download your current routine already filled into the Excel template. That way you can use it as a base, rearrange exercises, sets, repetitions, RIR and rests comfortably on the computer and, when you finish, import it back.
- **Import (PRO):** load that Excel template already filled in and the app rebuilds your routine from it. It closes the loop: you export your routine, edit it comfortably in Excel and re-import it so TrueLift applies it exactly as it is.

PRO routines ready to train (PRO)

If you have PRO, you don't need to create your routine from scratch: the app can automatically download a collection of PRO routines already designed and ready to train. They are complete, straightforward plans meant to cover practically any situation: for men and for women, for different numbers of training days per week, for those with lots of equipment or very little, and for those with more time per session or who need to train in less time. The idea is that you find an option that fits your context without prior work: you pick the one that suits you best, load it and start logging. From there it progresses like any other routine, and you can keep adjusting it or export it to Excel if you want to fine-tune it.

Create your routine with AI (PRO)

Can't find a routine that fits you? The app can create a **prompt with your needs** so that an external AI (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini...) generates a personalized routine that you will then import into TrueLift. The process:

- Answer the questionnaire (sex, age, experience, goal, days and session length, muscles to prioritize, aches, progression system, preferred structure, equipment you don't have and exercises to avoid) and the app will generate a tailored prompt.
- Export your routine to Excel from "Routine actions → Export or create your routine". That file is the template the AI must fill in.
- Open your trusted AI, paste the prompt and attach the Excel file in the same message.
- Get the routine into the Excel: if the AI returns the filled file, use it as is; if it gives you a table, copy the values into the Day 1-5 tabs. The Excel dropdowns will warn you if a value is not valid.
- Come back to the app and import the file from "Routine actions → Import routine from file".

Before using AI: the best option is almost always a routine from the app itself (the built-in ones or the PRO routines), designed and tested to work with its progression engine. And always review the resulting routine: the external AI does not know your technique or your history. When in doubt, less volume and more margin (RIR).

Top set + back-offs (PRO)

What it is. The top set is your strongest set of the day: the first set of the exercise, with the highest weight and the lowest RIR, the one that marks your level and from which progression is derived. The back-offs (or back sets) are the sets that come afterwards, with a slightly lower weight —the back-off percentage you chose— to accumulate quality volume without repeating the maximum load. The idea is to squeeze the most out of one truly demanding set and then reduce the load a bit to keep adding

effective work with good technique. In practice: you give your all in the top set and complete the back-offs with margin.

In the routine editor, the main exercises (“big” pattern) show a “Top set + back-offs” switch. When you enable it, two settings appear: **back-off %** (from 5 to 30 %, in steps of 5) and **back RIR** (0-4). Set 1 is the top set; the rest are back-offs.

In the log, the weight field is renamed “Kg (top)”. Each back-off has its own kg field, auto-filled as $\text{top} \times (1 - \%)$ and rounded to the weight loadable with your plates. If you change the top kg, the back-offs follow; if you edit a back-off manually, that field is respected. The target RIR of the back-offs is auto-filled separately, also applying the adjustments for deload or the day’s state.

Progression and metrics: only the top set sets the exercise’s progression (repetition target, e1RM, plateaus and “same bar” records). Back-offs count toward session performance, intra-session fatigue, automatic deload and tonnage. Back-offs are not meant to progress by themselves: their weight is fixed relative to the top set and you only need to complete repetitions until your target RIR. Even so, all sets —top and back— are taken into account to compute the session’s performance.

Excel: the template includes three columns on each day: H “Top+Back (yes/no)” with a dropdown, I “back-off %” (5-30) and J “back RIR” (0-6), plus a note in Instructions. When exporting, TrueLift fills them in; when importing, it reads them. If they are empty or say “no”, they are interpreted as straight sets, so old templates can be imported without changes.

7. Your day to day: logging a session

The Log tab is where you will spend most of your time. When you open the app it is already positioned on the next session due (the one after the last you saved).

Before starting

- At the top you see the selected session and that session’s week. Each session type progresses independently.
- For each exercise, the app shows you the **Target** ($\text{sets} \times \text{reps} \cdot \text{RIR}$) and, below, **Last time** (the weight and reps you did last time), so you have an immediate reference.
- The suggested weight comes pre-filled automatically and is always a weight you can load with your configured equipment.

An important detail: “Last time” always shows your latest real session. If that session cannot anchor the progression (because it was a deload session, it was saved on an amber/red day, or it was trained at reduced intensity due to fatigue), the app explains it right below, in amber, and tells you which full-intensity session the suggestion is based on. So you will never wonder why the app “ignores” a session: it always tells you.

Recording the session

For each set, write the repetitions you did and the RIR (reps in reserve: how many you had left before failure). Enter the weight used (you can leave 0 in exercises without external load). A progress bar shows the percentage of the plan you reached, with a reference margin.

What is RIR? It is a simple way of measuring effort: an RIR of 2 means you could have done 2 more repetitions before failing. Recording it correctly is essential for the progression to be accurate. Be honest: an inflated RIR ends in increases that later don't work out. And if one day you don't log it, the app protects itself and applies only a prudent minimal increase until it gets that signal back (it will remind you in the suggestion message).

Log the real RIR of every set. Don't write the same value "from memory" for the whole table: enter the RIR of each set separately, exactly as it was. The app reads set by set, not a rough average, and each RIR influences how it interprets your effort, the estimate of your strength and the progression it will propose. In straight sets the goal is clear: hit the repetition target in every set —and, in double progression, reach the top of the range in all of them— and record the true RIR of each. That is what lets the engine control your progress precisely; two sessions with the same reps but different RIR lead to different decisions. One detail that makes a difference: don't do more repetitions than planned to "force" a lower RIR. If your target is 3×8-10 at RIR 1 and in the first set you reach 10 but still have one left (RIR 2), record 10 reps and RIR 2; don't do an eleventh repetition to bring it down to RIR 1. Logging the real RIR —even if it is higher than expected— is exactly the signal the engine needs. With that in mind, the rule is simple: you progress when you meet the repetition target in every set and, in addition, the overall RIR is equal to or higher than the target. That confirms the weight is under control and it's time to increase; if the overall RIR falls below the target, even if you hit the reps, the engine understands there is still consolidation to do.

Exercise unavailable and notes

Machine busy or equipment broken? You can mark an exercise as **Unavailable** that day (also when editing a saved session). The entry is kept as a record, but it does not count toward performance, volume, plateaus or progression, and it does not replace your last valid workout as a reference. In addition, each exercise accepts free-text **notes** (sensations, technique, grips...), saved with the session.

Saving and messages

Before saving you can rate the session's effort (RPE, from 1 to 10). It is optional and only counts if you touch it, but it is worth it: the engine uses it to adjust the next increase and monitor your accumulated fatigue (more detail in section 8).

When you tap **Save session**, TrueLift analyzes what you did and replies with clear messages:

- A performance message assessing how the session went compared to what was expected.
- A new-record notice if you improved your best estimated 1RM in a main (multi-joint) exercise.
- A congratulation for streaks if you chain complete training weeks.
- Messages with context: if you log on an amber or red day, the app reminds you that somewhat lower performance is expected; and in a deload week it confirms it is not evaluating performance (that is what's expected, not an error). If fatigue affects only one body region (for example, legs), the messages tell you so: "today there are fatigue signals affecting the lower body".

If you have the timer enabled between sets, logging each set starts the rest countdown.

Rest timer and alarm

The timer counts the rest between sets and sounds an alarm when it ends, even if the screen is off or you are listening to music (the alarm mixes with the audio, it doesn't cut it). The screen stays on while the countdown runs so you can see the remaining time.

Logging cardio

With the **Log cardio** button you record your cardio sessions: choose a type (or write your own name), the duration in minutes and the intensity or effort (RPE, from 1 to 10). Cardio appears marked in your history and in the calendar.

Cardio is not a mere note: with the duration and effort, the engine computes your weekly cardio load and compares it with what is usual for you. A week clearly more demanding than normal counts as a fatigue signal and, with auto-regulation (PRO), can prompt a deload suggestion. Log all your cardio sessions with realistic data, especially if you combine strength and endurance.

History

Below the log you have your session history (a list that loads efficiently even if you have hundreds of entries). If you logged in real time, each session also stores its duration. In each session you can:

- **Share:** generates an attractive image of the workout, ready for social media.
- **Edit:** fix the weight, repetitions, RIR, notes or date of an already saved session.
- **Delete:** erase that session.

You can also **Export to Excel** the entire history, or **Delete the whole history** (with double confirmation, for safety).

8. Your data is the engine: what to log and why

TrueLift doesn't guess: it learns from you. Every recommendation you see in the app —the suggested weight, the message when saving, the deload notice— comes from an engine that analyzes your logs and turns them into decisions. The consequence is direct: the quality of what the app recommends depends on the quality of what you log. This section tells you which signals the engine watches and what your training gains with each one.

We won't go into the formulas (that logic is private), but into what matters to you: which data the engine uses, what it uses them for and why it is worth logging them well.

Weight and repetitions: the foundation of everything

Every set you record feeds the estimate of your real strength (the estimated 1RM). The engine doesn't rely only on your best set: it combines the best one with the session as a whole, so that one occasionally optimistic set doesn't inflate the recommendation. With that estimate it decides whether it's time to increase, how much, and when it's better to consolidate.

In bodyweight or weighted exercises (pull-ups, dips, push-ups), the engine computes your strength using your body weight plus the added load —also in assisted exercises, where the load can be negative—. That is why it is important to keep your body weight up to date in the settings: if it changes and you don't update it, your estimates and your progress chart will drift without you noticing.

RIR: the small piece of data that changes things the most

RIR (reps in reserve) tells the engine how far from failure you are working. With it, the app adjusts each increase: if you still have reps to spare, it can be a bit more ambitious; if you are at the limit, it protects you. Two pieces of advice:

- **Be honest.** An inflated RIR translates into unrealistic strength estimates and weights that later don't work. It is better to fall short than to overshoot.
- **Don't leave it blank.** If one day you don't log the RIR, the app doesn't break, but it turns cautious: it will apply only a minimal increase until it recovers that signal. Logging less will never give you more aggressive recommendations; it will give you more conservative ones, by definition.

Session effort (RPE)

When saving the session you can rate your overall effort from 1 to 10 (RPE). It is optional, and only counts if you touch it: the app never makes up a value for you. If you log it, the engine uses it for two things: modulating the next increase (meeting the target easily is not the same as meeting it in agony) and monitoring your accumulated internal load, one of the signals that anticipates fatigue before it shows in your weights.

Cardio counts too

With the duration and effort (1–10) you log, the engine computes your weekly cardio load and compares it with what is usual for you. A cardio week clearly more demanding than normal counts as a fatigue signal and, with auto-regulation (PRO), can even prompt a deload suggestion. If you combine strength and endurance, log all your cardio with realistic data: it is the only way for the app to consider your full training, and not just half of it.

Log in the moment, not from memory

Record each set as you do it. RIR remembered hours later is much less reliable, and the app also automatically stores the duration of your sessions when you log in real time (you will see it in your history). Consistent logging with the same criteria is worth more than a perfect one once in a while: the engine learns from your patterns, and patterns need consistency.

How fatigue is computed

The app doesn't measure your fatigue with a sensor: it infers it from the signals you already log, always comparing them with what is usual for you, not with an absolute value. Four things weigh the most: the real RIR of your sets (training session after session closer to failure than planned accumulates fatigue), your performance relative to your baseline (repeatedly underperforming), the session effort (RPE) you log when saving, and your weekly cardio load. With PRO auto-regulation, your daily state (sleep, stress, aches, energy) and HRV are added. The engine doesn't react to one isolated bad day: it watches the trend across several sessions, so a one-off dip won't hold you back, but a sustained accumulation slows the pace of increases and, if pronounced, triggers the deload suggestion. Back-offs and tonnage also feed that internal-load reading. That's why, the more complete and honest your logs, the better the app distinguishes between "you are strong and can push" and "you need to recover".

With PRO, the engine sees twice as much

Everything above works in the free version. The PRO version adds the signals from outside the gym: your sleep, your stress, your aches (with their region), your energy, your HRV and your diet phase. With them, the engine doesn't just decide how much to increase: it decides when to accelerate, when to brake and when to protect you. Every extra piece of data you log is a finer adjustment. You can try it free for 28 days.

9. How the app progresses

You don't have to compute anything: TrueLift decides the load of your next session from your logs. Broadly, this is how it works from your point of view:

- If you meet the target (all sets with the expected repetitions and RIR), the app proposes raising the weight next time. The increment is small and proportional to the exercise: more in the big basics, less in isolation work.
- If you fall short, it keeps the weight to consolidate before increasing again.
- The increase is not blind: it takes into account how your last session really went. If you met the target but at the limit (very high effort or just-enough performance), the increase will be smaller; if you were clearly comfortable, it will be somewhat larger. When the app decides to be prudent, it tells you in the message itself ("moderate increase...").
- **Anti-plateau:** if you chain several sessions without completing the target at the same weight, the app first warns you that the next attempt is decisive and, if you remain stuck, proposes a small step back in load to gain momentum and climb again by accumulating repetitions. It's what a good coach would do: staying at the same weight for months is no longer an option.
- **Reordering test (PRO):** before the step back, if the stuck exercise is not the first of its day, the app tries one session moving it to the first slot, fresh. Sometimes the plateau is accumulated fatigue from the previous exercises and not a real ceiling. If doing it first unblocks the exercise, it returns to its place and you keep progressing without stepping back; if it still doesn't work, the step back is applied and the app confirms it was a real ceiling. The rest of that day's exercises train normally and their progression is unaffected.
- If you come back after a break of several weeks, the app doesn't demand you continue where you left off: it proposes resuming with prudence and "relearning" your real level in a few sessions, without marking weak sessions compared to your old self. The longer the break, the gentler the return.
- Several days rated only as "so-so" with PRO auto-regulation? The engine doesn't freeze: it warns you to check sleep and stress, and meanwhile keeps progressing prudently with the available information.
- Your history is stable: each session is evaluated with the criteria of the day you saved it. Changing the diet phase later does not rewrite your past sessions.
- The proposed weight can always be loaded with your equipment: on the barbell it rises in increments of the smallest plate placed on both sides; on machines, plate by plate; with dumbbells, according to the increment you specified (and your microplates, if enabled).
- Each session type progresses separately, so if an exercise appears on two different days, it advances independently in each.

In double progression, instead of raising the weight every time, you first accumulate repetitions within the range; when you reach the maximum in all sets, the app gives you the weight increase and the range restarts.

10. Optional features (PRO)

These features are optional: the app works without them. They are designed for those who want to adjust training to their state and context. All of them belong to the PRO version.

Auto-regulation (daily state)

It lets you record each day how you are: sleep, mood/energy, muscle soreness, stress, joint pain and illness. With that information, the app can adjust the session to your real readiness: if you accumulate several bad days it will take it into account and adapt the training. If it detects relevant fatigue signals, it will suggest a deload which, if you accept, will regulate training in deload mode for one or two weeks. And if one day you don't record your state, the app does not assume you are fine —absence of data is not a good signal—: it will remind you before suggesting increases. There is only one entry per day: saving again replaces the previous one.

How to score sleep and mood. Always score relative to your normality, not to an ideal. If you slept the way you usually sleep —even if you feel it is “never perfect”— that is a 4, not a 3: the 3 is for nights truly worse than normal and the 5 for exceptional rest. The same goes for mood and energy: an ordinary day, with nothing standing out negatively, is a 4. Recording your normal day as a 4 is not settling (keep trying to sleep and recover better), but it prevents the engine from reading a dip that doesn't actually exist and slowing you down without reason.

Muscle soreness is not joint pain. Distinguish the two well when recording discomfort. Soreness (DOMS) is that diffuse feeling in the muscle itself one or two days after training, especially after new exercises or higher volume: it is normal, part of the process, and should not be recorded as pain. Joint pain is something else: it is sharp or localized in a joint (knee, shoulder, elbow, hip...), usually appears during the movement and indicates something is off. That one you should record, always specifying the affected region, so the app protects only the exercises of that region without holding back the rest. If you record simple soreness as pain, the system will over-limit you; if you ignore real joint pain, it won't be able to look after you.

Fatigue and pain by region: lower and upper body

Both joint pain and strong soreness are recorded with their **region**: general, lower body or upper body. The app classifies each exercise by its region (by muscle group and pattern) and applies protection only where it belongs: a knee issue will slow down your squat, but not your bench press; 4/4 leg soreness will not raise the RIR of your presses. Systemic signals (sleep, mood, stress, HRV, illness) affect both regions. The log messages tell you the affected region (“Joint pain (lower body)”, “today there are fatigue signals affecting the upper body”), and in the recent-readiness history in Progress each non-green day shows its region with a letter: **G** (general), **L** (lower body) or **U** (upper body).

HRV (heart rate variability)

Within auto-regulation you can enter each day your average nightly HRV (whatever your watch or band reports) and, optionally, your nightly resting heart rate. It counts as one more signal of your daily

state and your recovery relative to training. If one night's reading is unreliable (bad measurement), you can discard it and it won't count.

Optionally you can set a manual reference band (the one your watch gives, if you already have history); over time, the app learns your personal band from your own measurements and tells you how many nights are left to activate the automatic band.

The engine only reacts to the **sustained signal**, not to one isolated bad night: it takes at least two low nights in a row, or a multi-day trend below your band, for HRV to modulate training; one good night breaks the streak instantly, and the modulation switches itself off as soon as the average recovers. It is a feature for advanced users: if you don't measure your HRV, leave it off.

State to train and readiness (0–100)

When you use auto-regulation, the app summarizes your availability in two mutually consistent ways: a **state banner** (green, amber or red) with the day's reasons, and a **readiness-to-train** indicator from 0 to 100 with a color ring by bands (0–39 red, 40–69 amber, 70–100 green). Tap it to see the breakdown of which signals (sleep, stress, HRV, recent performance, accumulated training and cardio load...) are adding or subtracting. If your recent performance is weak, the banner itself tells you ("Recent performance weak: today we keep loads..."), even if your questionnaire for the day is good.

Diet phase

Indicate which nutritional phase you are in so the app modulates the aggressiveness of the progression:

- **Deficit:** you are eating below your maintenance (cutting). The app is more conservative with increases.
- **Maintenance:** balanced behavior (it is the default value).
- **Surplus:** you eat above maintenance (bulking). The app is somewhat more permissive with increases.

The effect intensifies with the weeks you spend in the selected phase. If you don't control your diet, leave it at Maintenance: it is the neutral option and the one that avoids misreadings. In the free version it stays fixed at Maintenance.

11. Deload mode

A deload is a light week to recover: fewer sets, higher RIR, around 10 % less load and progression on pause. It is not losing progress, it is protecting it.

- You can activate it in the settings (**Deload mode**, a PRO feature). The app notifies you when the week is complete and lets you end it or keep it one more week; if you keep it, it deactivates itself when it ends.
- When the deload closes, progression resumes from the weights you had before starting it, not from the reduced weights of the light week.
- With auto-regulation enabled, the app can also **suggest a deload** when it detects signs of accumulated fatigue, a performance drop, many consecutive days in bad shape (even if your numbers don't show it yet) or a cardio week far above usual. Every so many weeks, it also invites

you to honestly assess whether your body needs one —only if you have trained regularly enough to need it.

- During the deload, when saving each session the app confirms it is not evaluating your performance nor using that week for your comparisons. It is intentional: the light week doesn't pollute your statistics or your progress.
- The automatic suggestions are sensible: after finishing a deload there is a grace period without new suggestions (the small dip on return is normal and expected), and pain only counts as a reason if it is recent, not because of an episode already resolved.

12. Volume tab

This tab tells you whether you are training each muscle group with the right volume. It shows two things:

- **Effective sets per week** per muscle group (the exercise's primary group counts $\times 1$ and secondary ones $\times 0.5$), according to your current selection of exercises and sets.
- **Weekly frequency**: how many days you train each group.

The color reference guides you at a glance (example for men; for women the values are slightly different, as they tolerate more volume):

Sets / week	Meaning
4 or fewer	Too low
5 – 9	Effective minimum / maintenance
10 – 20	Target zone (start at the lower end)
21 or more	Very high — watch your recovery

As for frequency, training a group two or more days per week is usually preferable for most goals.

13. Progress tab

Here you see how you evolve over time. It includes, among others:

- **Last session's tonnage**: the total kilos moved (weight $\times$ repetitions).
- **Estimated 1RM**: an estimate of your one-repetition maximum from your last set, computed with a standard formula that takes RIR into account and protected against very high-rep sets, which are the noisiest.
- **Estimated e1RM per session**: the evolution of your best estimated 1RM in each session, to see the trend. Essential to know whether you are really progressing.
- **Your level**: your strength level per exercise, comparing your best estimated 1RM with your body weight (strength-to-weight ratio) according to common standards by sex: Beginner, Novice, Intermediate, Advanced and Elite. It is a guide: useful to know your starting point and celebrate milestones, not to compare yourself with anyone.

- **Recent readiness (PRO):** a summary of your recent daily-state days (green, amber and red). Today's cell is computed live and always matches the log banner; non-green days show the affected region with its letter (G general, L lower body, S upper body), with a legend below.
- **Personal records:** your best estimated 1RM per exercise. Only the big multi-joint lifts are listed (squats, deadlift, presses, pull-ups/pulldowns and rows), which are the ones that define your real strength.
- **HRV per day (PRO):** the evolution of your HRV measurements.
- **Performance:** a chart telling you whether you are performing above or below your baseline, showing the thresholds.
- **Duration of your sessions:** if you log in real time, the app records by itself how long your workouts last and you can see their evolution.

From this tab you can also generate the **Monthly report:** an HTML summary with your trained days, compliance, sessions, tonnage, repetitions and e1RM evolution, ready to share or save.

14. Support tools

Plate calculator

Accessible from the dumbbell icon (top). Enter the target weight and the bar weight and it tells you exactly which plates to put on each side, using only the plates you configured as available (including the fractional-plate limitation). If the target cannot be formed exactly, it warns you how much is missing.

Warm-up sets

On the same screen, enter your 1RM for a main exercise and the app proposes a 5-set warm-up ramp (3 mandatory and 2 optional), progressively raising the weight and lowering the repetitions, to reach your working sets without accumulating fatigue.

Rest timer

Already described in the log section: it manages the rest between sets with an audible alarm even if the screen is off. You can enable or disable it in the settings (Countdown between sets). Note! The app keeps the screen on; if you turn it off manually, the timer will continue, but the audible alert will not sound until you turn the screen on.

15. Sharing your training

TrueLift makes it easy to share your progress:

- **Share session:** from the history, it generates an image card with the date, tonnage, total repetitions and the exercise breakdown, with the TrueLift brand and website.
- **Monthly report:** from Progress, create a summary of the month to share or archive.

16. Backup

Your data lives on your phone. To avoid losing it, use the backups (in settings):

- **Export backup:** saves all your information (routine, history and settings) in a file. Keep it in a safe place.
- **Restore:** loads a backup onto another phone or after reinstalling. It replaces all current data with the backup's, so use it carefully.

The backup is also the way to show your training to a coach: export it and send it to them; it contains your routine and your entire history.

17. Recommendations by level

If you are starting out

- Use **Simple linear**: it is the most efficient way to start.
- Prioritize technique and record RIR honestly; that is what makes the progression work.
- Set up your equipment, log your sessions and let the app guide you.

If you are experienced

- When linear progression stalls, switch to **Double progression**.
- It will let you progress more slowly and precisely when simple progression is exhausted and adding weight every week is no longer viable.
- Consider enabling **Top set + back-offs** on the big basics: squeeze one demanding set and accumulate the rest of the volume with margin.
- Enable **auto-regulation** (PRO) and log your daily state, session effort and cardio: the more the engine "sees", the finer it tunes each decision.
- If you combine strength and endurance, log all your cardio with realistic duration and effort: the engine will watch your total load, not just the weights.

18. Frequently asked questions

Do I lose my data if the PRO trial ends? No. Your routine and history are kept; only the advanced features are locked until you buy the PRO version.

Is the PRO version a subscription? It can be or not, you choose. There are three options: subscription (recurring payment), annual payment and lifetime payment (a single payment that never expires and is equivalent to having it forever). All are managed by Google Play and can be restored on any phone with your Google account.

Why won't it let me change the sets or the RIR? Adjusting sets, RIR, repetitions and rest is a PRO feature. Try it with the free 28 days or unlock it with the purchase.

I can't load the weight it proposes with my plates. Check your equipment settings: 1.25 plates, microloading (the master switch and how many plates you have) and the dumbbell increment. The app only proposes weights loadable with what you specify.

"Last time" shows one session, but the suggestion is based on another. Why? Because that last session cannot anchor the progression: it was a deload session, it was saved on an amber/red day, or it was trained at reduced intensity due to fatigue. The app explains it right below "Last time" and tells

you which full-intensity session the suggestion comes from. It is not a bug: it is the engine protecting your references.

What if a machine is busy or broken? Mark the exercise as Unavailable that day. It remains on record in the history, but it doesn't count toward performance, plateaus or progression, and it doesn't spoil your references.

Do I have to use HRV and auto-regulation? No. They are optional. Progression works without them, but it won't have the optimizations provided in the PRO version.

I don't control my diet, what do I set as the phase? Leave it at Maintenance. It is the neutral option.

I've had several sessions without completing the target at the same weight. What will happen? The app detects it: first it warns you that the next attempt is decisive; with PRO it can also try moving the exercise to the first slot of its day (reordering test) in case the block was fatigue from the previous exercises; and if you still can't get out, it proposes a small step back in load to break the block and climb again with momentum. You will not stay stuck indefinitely.

I haven't trained for a few weeks. Do I resume where I left off? The app will suggest resuming with prudence instead of demanding your last weight, and within a few sessions it recalibrates your real level. It is normal that the first sessions are not compared against your history: the engine is "taking references" again.

Why is the increase smaller this time than other times? Because the engine adjusts each increase according to how your last session really went: if it was very demanding (high RPE or just-enough performance), if you are in a deficit or if you didn't log the RIR, it increases with prudence. It is not a fault: it is a sign it is doing its job.

What is the session effort (RPE) for when saving? It is an overall rating from 1 to 10. If you record it, the app uses it to adjust the next increase and monitor your accumulated fatigue. If you don't touch it, it simply doesn't count: the app never makes up a value for you.

My leg hurts. Will everything stop progressing? No. With auto-regulation (PRO), if you indicate the pain region in your daily state, the app only slows the affected exercises: a knee issue doesn't stop your bench press. The same happens with strong localized soreness.

I slept badly last night and my HRV came out low. Will the app hold me back? One isolated bad night doesn't modulate anything: the engine only reacts to the sustained signal (at least two low nights in a row or a multi-day trend). If it is a one-off dip, train normally.

Does cardio affect my weights? It doesn't directly change your strength loads, but it counts as training load: a cardio week far above usual adds to your fatigue signals and, with auto-regulation (PRO), can prompt the app to suggest a deload.

Can I switch from kg to pounds without ruining my history? Yes. The app stores your data internally with full precision and only changes what you see. You can switch between units whenever you want.

19. About the author

TrueLift was created by Rubén Soro. His approach: evidence-based training, with no shortcuts and no hype, so you progress with sound judgement in every session.

Author's website: www.rubensoro.es

App website: www.truelift.es

TrueLift — Train with sound judgement.